

# Being Different Helps

You could make a GPS product, but there are too many. You could make a game console, but again there are too many. So how do you pick a popular segment, and yet make a product that wins? By being different! For example, adding an anti-theft component to a GPS product, a touch-free scanner to an access control system, or a charger that draws power from a cooking pot might kindle buyers' curiosity. Let us look at a couple of such products that bring an interesting twist to their respective segment

## EFY BUREAU



### Capturing images in the wild—with no power

Suppose you are camping or trekking and your camera runs out of power just when you are witnessing a breath-taking sunset that you want to capture? Indeed, there are several devices today that provide portable power—there are solar chargers, kinetic chargers and other such innovative options cropping up, but Superheadz's Sun & Cloud offers a much better solution. Japanese company Superheadz has come up with a hand-cranked digital camera that works on self-generated power.

**Inside:** Sun & Cloud is capable of shooting both videos and stills, and has most of the features of a normal digital camera. What makes it unique is that it does not rely on batteries or grid power, and can be charged using kinetic energy from a hand crank. It is also equipped with a solar panel for sunny days, and is capable of USB charging when available. Sun & Cloud comes with 15 built-in filters, a three megapixel lens and three shooting modes (normal, portrait and macro). It has a high-power LED light for night shots, a built-in microphone for audio recording, and support for micro SD and micro SDHC cards. Just because it has a hand crank, do not assume that it will be huge and heavy—it measures 15.2×15.2×20.3 cm<sup>3</sup> and weighs just 200 gm.

### A tool to help golfers practice

Motion-sensor-based sports training aids are becoming popular today, and there are such tools for golf practice too. However, golfers grudge that these tools help only in the full swing and are not effective with smaller strokes. Putting, however, is very important and experts often call it a game within the game. It accounts for over 40 per cent of a golfer's strokes. So it is important that a player is good at putting too. Here is a golf motion analyser that is small and light enough to fit into the corner of the putter's grip. With extremely capable sensors and a smart app, 3BaysGSA PUTT can analyse key aspects of putting strokes very well indeed.

**Inside:** 3BaysGSA PUTT is a tiny device made of light plastic-like material. It uses a motion-sensing engine with 9-axis sensors that can detect, capture and digitise even the subtlest of movements. The device is to be fitted on the putter, and paired to your mobile phone using a Bluetooth. Thereafter, the sensor information is transferred to your mobile phone and analysed using an intelligent algorithm. Clear graphic representations of the stroke path, along with several key statistics are displayed on your device, and stored for later analysis as well. The small device is chargeable, and works for around three to four hours on each charge.

